THE FIRST EPISTLE OF PAUL TO THE

THESSALONIANS

Salutation. Thanksgiving for their Reception of the Gospel. Reminder of his Labors among them

1 [a]Paul, and [b]Silvanus, and [c]Timothy, unto the [d]church of the Thessalonians in God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ: [e]Grace to you and peace.

2 [f]We give thanks to God always for you all, [g]making mention *of you* in our prayers; 3 remembering without ceasing your [h]work of faith and labor of [i]love and [1k]patience of hope in our Lord Jesus Christ, before [2l]our God and Father; 4 knowing, [m]brethren beloved of God, [n]your election, 5 [3]how that our [4o]gospel came not unto you in word only, but also [p]in power, and in the Holy Spirit, and *in* much [5q]assurance; even as ye know [r]what manner of men we showed ourselves toward you for your sake. 6 And ye became [s]imitators of us, and of the Lord, [t]having received [u]the word in much affliction, with [v]joy of the Holy Spirit; 7 so that ye became an ensample to all that believe in [x]Macedonia and in [y]Achaia. 8 For from you hath [z]sounded forth [a]the word of the Lord, not only in [x]Macedonia and [y]Achaia, but [b]in every place your faith to God-ward is gone forth; so that we need not to speak anything. 9 For they themselves report concerning us what manner of [c]entering in we had unto you; and how ye [d]turned unto God [e]from idols, to serve a [f]living and true God, 10 and to [g]wait for his Son from heaven, whom he [h]raised from the dead, *even* Jesus, who [i]delivereth us from [k]the wrath to come.

2 For yourselves, brethren, know our [l]entering in unto you, that [m]it hath not been found vain: 2 but having suffered before and been [n]shamefully treated, as ye know, at [o]Philippi, we waxed bold in our God [p]to speak unto you the [4q]gospel of God in much [r]conflict. 3 For our [s]exhortation *is* not of [t]error, nor of [u]uncleanness, nor in [v]guile: 4 [x]but even as we have been approved of God to be [y]intrusted with the [4]gospel, so we speak; [z]not as pleasing men, but God who [a]proveth our hearts. 5 For neither at any time were we found using words of flattery, as ye know, nor [b]a cloak of covetousness, [c]God is witness; 6 nor [d]seeking glory of men, neither from you nor from others, when we might have [6]claimed authority as [e]apostles of Christ. 7 But we were [7f]gentle in the midst of you, [g]as when a nurse cherisheth her own children: 8 even so, being affectionately desirous of you, we were well pleased to [h]impart unto you, not the [4q]gospel of God only, but also our own souls, because ye were become very dear to us. 9 For ye remember, brethren, our [i]labor and travail: [k]working night and day, that we might not [l]burden any of you, we preached unto you the [4q]gospel of God. 10 Ye are witnesses, and [m]God *also*, [n]how holily and righteously and unblamably we behaved ourselves toward you that believe: 11 as ye know how we *dealt with* each one of you, as [o]a father with his own children, [p]exhorting you, and encouraging *you*, and [q]testifying, 12 to the end that

1 Or, *stedfastness* 2 Or, *God and our Father* 3 Or, *because our gospel &c.* 4 Gr. *good tidings*: and so elsewhere; see marginal note on Mt. 4. 23. 5 Or, *fulness* 6 Or, *been burdensome* ver. 9; comp. 1 Cor. 9. 4 ff. 7 Most of the ancient authorities read *babes*. Comp. 1 Cor. 14. 20.

[a] 2 Th. 1. 1 [b] See 2 Cor. 1 19 [c] See Acts 16. 1 (2 Th. 1. 1) [d] 2 Th. 1. 1; comp. Acts 17. 1 [e] See Rom. 1. 7 [f] 2 Th. 1. 3; see Rom. 1. 8; Eph. 5. 20; comp. ch. 2. 13 [g] See Rom. 1. 9 [h] 2 Th. 1. 11; comp. Jn. 6. 29; Gal. 5. 6 [i] ch. 3. 6; 2 Th. 1. 3 f.; comp. 1 Cor. 13. 13 [k] Rom. 8. 25; 15. 4 [l] See Gal. 1. 4 [m] 2 Th. 2. 13; comp. Rom. 1. 7 [n] 2 Pet. 1. 10; comp. Rom. 9. 11 [o] See 2 Cor. 2. 12; 1 Cor. 9. 14; ch. 2. 2, 4, 8 f.; 3. 2; 2 Th. 2. 14 [p] See Rom. 15. 19; 1 Cor. 2. 4; 2 Cor. 6. 7 [q] Comp. Col. 2. 2; Lk. 1. 1 (Gr.) [r] ch. 2. 10 [s] See 1 Cor. 4. 16; comp. 11. 1 f. [t] Acts 17. 5–10 [u] See 2 Tim. 4. 2 [v] Acts 13. 52; comp. 2 Cor. 6. 10; Gal. 5. 22 [x] See Rom. 15. 26 [y] See Acts 18. 12 [z] See Rom. 10. 18 [a] 2 Th. 3. 1; comp. Col. 3. 16 [b] Rom. 1. 8; Cor. 2. 14; comp. Rom. 16. 19 [c] ch. 2. 1 [d] Acts 14. 15 [e] Comp. 1 Cor. 12. 2 [f] See Mt. 16. 16 [g] See Mt. 16. 27 f.; 1 Cor. 1. 7 [h] See Acts 2. 24 [i] See Rom. 5. 9 [k] Mt. 3. 7; comp. ch. 2. 16; 5. 9 [l] ch. 1. 9 [m] 2 Th. 1. 10 [n] Phil. 1. 30; Acts 14. 5 [o] See Acts 16. 22–24 [p] See Acts 17. 1–9 — [q] See Rom. 1. 1 [r] See Phil. 1. 30 [s] Acts 13. 15 [t] 2 Th. 2. 11 [u] ch. 4. 7 [v] 2 Cor. 4. 2 [x] 2 Cor. 2. 17 [y] See Gal. 2. 7 [z] See Gal. 1. 10 [a] See Rom. 8. 27 [b] Acts 20. 33; comp. 2 Pet. 2. 3 [c] ver. 10; see Rom. 1. 9 [d] Jn. 5. 41, 44; comp. 2 Cor. 4. 5 [e] See 1 Cor. 9. 1 f. [f] 2 Tim. 2. 24. [g] Comp. ver. 11; Gal. 4. 19 [h] See 2 Cor. 12. 15; comp. 1 Jn. 3. 16 [i] 2 Th. 3. 8; comp. Phil. 4. 16 [k] See Acts 18. 3 [l] 2 Cor. 11. 9; comp. 1 Cor. 9. 4 f. [m] See ver. 5 [n] ch. 1. 5; comp. 2 Cor. 1. 12 [o] See 1 Cor. 4. 14; comp. ver. 7 [p] Comp. ch. 5. 14 [q] See Lk. 16. 28; ch. 4. 6

ye should [a] walk worthily of God, who [1] [b] calleth you into his own kingdom and [c] glory.

13 And for this cause we also [d] thank God without ceasing, that, when ye received from us [2] [e] the word of the message, *even the word* of God, ye accepted *it* [f] not *as* the word of men, but, as it is in truth, the word of God, [g] which also worketh in you that believe. 14 For ye, brethren, became [h] imitators of [i] the churches of God which are [k] in Judæa in Christ Jesus: for [l] ye also suffered the same things of your own countrymen, [m] even as they did of the Jews; 15 [n] who both killed the Lord Jesus and [o] the prophets, and drove out us, and please not God, and are contrary to all men; 16 [p] forbidding us to speak to the Gentiles [q] that they may be saved; to [r] fill up their sins always: but the [s] wrath is come upon them to the uttermost.

17 But we, brethren, being bereaved of you for [3] a short season, [t] in presence not in heart, endeavored the more exceedingly [u] to see your face with great desire: 18 because [v] we would fain have come unto you, I Paul [x] once and again; and [y] Satan [z] hindered us. 19 For what is our hope, or [a] joy, or crown of glorying? Are not even ye, before our Lord Jesus at his [4] [b] coming? 20 For ye are [c] our glory and our joy.

3 Wherefore [d] when we could no longer forbear, we thought it good to be left behind at [e] Athens alone; 2 and sent [f] Timothy, our brother and [5] God's minister in the [6] gospel of Christ, to establish you, and to comfort *you* concerning your faith; 3 that no man be moved by these afflictions; for yourselves know that [g] hereunto we are appointed. 4 For verily, when we were with you, we told you [7] beforehand that we are to suffer affliction; [h] even as it came to pass, and ye know. 5 For this cause I also, [d] when I could no longer forbear, [i] sent that I might know your faith, lest by any means [k] the tempter had tempted you, and [l] our labor should be in vain. 6 But when [m] Timothy came even now unto us from you, and brought us glad tidings of [n] your faith and love, and that ye have [o] good remembrance of us always, longing to see us, even as we also *to see* you; 7 for this cause, brethren, we were comforted over you in all our distress and affliction through your faith: 8 for now we live, if ye [p] stand fast in the Lord. 9 For [q] what thanksgiving can we render again unto God for you, for all the joy wherewith we joy for your sakes before our God; 10 [r] night and day praying exceedingly that we may [s] see your face, and may [t] perfect that which is lacking in your faith?

11 [u] Now may [8] [v] our God and Father [x] himself, and our Lord Jesus, [y] direct our way unto you: 12 and the Lord make you to increase and [z] abound in love one toward another, and toward all men, even as we also *do* toward you; 13 to the end he may [a] establish your hearts [b] unblamable in holiness before [9] [v] our God and Father, at [c] the [4] coming of our Lord Jesus [d] with all his saints.[10]

4 [e] Finally then, [f] brethren, we beseech and exhort you in the Lord Jesus, that, as ye received of us how ye ought to [g] walk and to [h] please God, even as ye do walk, — that ye [z] abound more and more. 2 For ye know what [11] charge we gave you through the Lord Jesus. 3 For this is the will of God, *even* your sanctification, that ye [a] abstain from fornication; 4 that [k] each one of you know how to possess himself of his own [l] vessel in sanctification and [m] honor, 5 not in the [n] passion of lust, even as the Gentiles who [o] know not God; 6 that no man [12] transgress, and [p] wrong his brother [q] in the matter: because [r] the Lord is an avenger in all these things, as

[a] See Eph. 4. 1
[b] ch. 5. 24; 2 Th. 2. 14; see Rom. 8. 28
[c] 1 Pet. 5. 10; comp. 2 Cor. 4. 6
[d] See Rom. 1. 8; comp. ch. 1. 2
[e] Heb. 4. 2; comp. Rom. 10. 17
[f] Comp. Gal. 4. 14; see Mt. 10. 20
[g] Comp. Heb. 4. 12
[h] ch. 1. 6
[i] See 1 Cor. 7. 17; comp. 10. 32
[k] See Gal. 1. 22
[l] Acts 17. 5; comp. ch. 3. 4; 2 Th. 1. 4 f.
[m] Comp. Heb. 10. 33 f.
[n] Lk. 24. 20; Acts 2. 23
[o] Acts 7. 52, see Mt. 5. 12
[p] Acts 9. 23, 13. 45, 50; 14. 2, 5, 19; 17. 5, 13; 18. 12; 21. 21 f., 27; 25. 2, 7
[q] 1 Cor. 10. 33
[r] Gen. 15. 16; Dan. 8. 23; Mt. 23. 32
[s] See ch. 1. 10
[t] See 1 Cor. 5. 3
[u] ch. 3. 10
[v] Comp. Rom. 15. 22
[x] Phil. 4. 16
[y] See Mt. 4. 10
[z] Rom. 15. 22; comp. Rom. 1. 13
[a] Phil. 4. 1
[b] ch. 3. 13; 4. 15; 5. 23; see Mt. 16. 27; Mk. 8. 38; Jn. 21. 22
[c] 2 Cor. 1. 14
[d] ver. 5; comp. Phil. 2. 19
[e] See Acts 17. 15 f.
[f] See 2 Cor. 1. 1; Col. 1. 1
[g] See Acts 9. 16; 14. 22
[h] See ch. 2. 14
[i] ver. 2
[k] Mt. 4. 3
[l] See Phil. 2. 16; comp. 2 Cor. 6. 1
[m] Acts 18. 5

[n] ch. 1. 3 [o] Comp. 1 Cor. 11. 2 [p] Comp. 1 Cor. 16. 13 [q] ch. 1. 2 [r] 2 Tim. 1. 3 [s] ch. 2. 17 [t] See 2 Cor. 13. 9 [u] Comp. 2 Th. 2. 16 [v] See Gal. 1. 4; ver. 13 [x] ch. 4. 16; 5. 23; 2 Th. 2. 16; 3. 16; Rev. 21. 3 [y] Comp. 2 Th. 3. 5 [z] Phil. 1. 9; comp. ch. 4. 1, 10; 2 Th. 1. 3 [a] See 1 Cor. 1. 8; comp. ver. 2 [b] See Lk. 1. 6 [c] See ch. 2. 19 [d] Comp. Mt. 25. 31, Mk. 8. 38; 2 Th. 1. 7; but also ch. 4. 17 [e] 2 Th. 3. 1; see 2 Cor. 13. 11 [f] ch. 5. 12; 2 Th. 1. 3; 2. 1; 3. 1, 13; see Gal. 6. 1 [g] See Eph. 4. 1 [h] Comp. 2 Cor. 5. 9 [i] See 1 Cor. 6. 18 [k] 1 Cor. 7. 2, 9 [l] 1 Pet. 3. 7; comp. 2 Cor. 4. 7 [m] Comp. Rom. 1. 24 [n] Comp. Rom. 1. 26 [o] See Gal. 4. 8 [p] Comp. 1 Cor. 6. 8 [q] 2 Cor. 7. 11 [r] Heb. 13. 4; comp Rom. 12. 19; 13. 4

[1] Some ancient authorities read *called*.
[2] Gr. *the word of hearing*. Gal. 3. 2, 5.
[3] Gr. *a season of an hour*.
[4] Gr. *presence*. Comp. 2 Cor. 10. 10.
[5] Some ancient authorities read *fellow-worker with God*.
[6] Gr. *good tidings*: see ch. 1. 5.
[7] Or, *plainly*

[8] Or, *God himself and our Father*
[9] Or, *God and our Father*
[10] Many ancient authorities add *Amen*.
[11] Gr. *charges*.
[12] Or, *overreach*

also we [1] forewarned you and [a] testified. 7 For [b] God called us not for [c] uncleanness, but in sanctification. 8 Therefore he that rejecteth, rejecteth not man, but God, who [d] giveth his Holy Spirit unto you.

9 But concerning [e] love of the brethren ye [f] have no need that one write unto you: for ye yourselves are [g] taught of God to love one another; 10 for indeed [h] ye do it toward all the brethren that are in all Macedonia. But we exhort you, brethren, that ye [i] abound more and more; 11 and that ye [2] study [k] to be quiet, and to [l] do your own business, and to [m] work with your hands, even as we charged you; 12 that ye may [n] walk becomingly toward [o] them that are without, and may [p] have need of nothing.

13 But [q] we would not have you ignorant, brethren, concerning them that [r] fall asleep; that ye sorrow not, even as [s] the rest, who have [t] no hope. 14 For if we believe that Jesus died and rose again, [u] even so [v] them also that are fallen asleep [3] in Jesus will God bring with him. 15 For this we say unto you [x] by the word of the Lord, that [y] we that are alive, that are left unto [z] the [4] coming of the Lord, shall in no wise precede [v] them that are fallen asleep. 16 For the Lord [a] himself [b] shall descend from heaven, with [c] a shout, with the voice of [d] the archangel, and with [e] the trump of God: and [f] the dead in Christ shall rise first; 17 then [y] we that are alive, that are left, shall together with them be [g] caught up [h] in the clouds, to meet the Lord in the air: and so shall we ever [i] be with the Lord. 18 Wherefore [5] comfort one another with these words.

5 But concerning the [k] times and the seasons, brethren, ye [l] have no need that aught be written unto you. 2 For yourselves know perfectly that [m] the day of the Lord so cometh [n] as a thief in the night. 3 When they are saying, [o] Peace and safety, then sudden [p] destruction cometh upon them, as [q] travail upon a woman with child; and they shall in no wise escape. 4 But ye, brethren, are not in [r] darkness, that that day should overtake you [6] [n] as a thief: 5 for ye are all [s] sons of light, and sons of the day: we are not of the night, nor of [r] darkness; 6 so then let us not [t] sleep, as do [u] the rest, but let us watch and [v] be sober. 7 For they that sleep sleep in the night; and they that are drunken are [z] drunken in the night. 8 But let us, since [y] we are of the day, [v] be sober, putting on the [z] breastplate of [a] faith and love; and for a [b] helmet, the [c] hope of salvation. 9 For God appointed us not unto [d] wrath, but unto [e] the obtaining of salvation through our Lord Jesus Christ, 10 [f] who died for us, that, whether we [7] wake or sleep, we should live together with him. 11 Wherefore [8] exhort one another, and [g] build each other up, even as also ye do.

12 But we beseech you, brethren, to [h] know them [i] that labor among you, and [k] are over you in the Lord, and admonish you; 13 and to esteem them exceeding highly in love for their work's sake. [l] Be at peace among yourselves. 14 And we exhort you, brethren, admonish [m] the disorderly, encourage [n] the faint-hearted, support [o] the weak, be [p] longsuffering toward all. 15 See that [q] none render unto any one evil for evil; but always [r] follow after that which is good, one toward another, and toward all. 16 [s] Rejoice always; 17 [t] pray without ceasing; 18 in everything [u] give thanks: for this is the will of God in Christ Jesus to you-ward. 19 [v] Quench not the Spirit; 20 despise not [x] prophesyings; 21 [9] [y] prove all things; [r] hold fast that which is good; 22 abstain from every form of evil.

23 And [z] the God of peace [a] himself sanctify you wholly; and may

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[1] Or, *told you plainly*
[2] Gr. *be ambitious.* See Rom. 15. 20 marg.
[3] Gr. *through.* Or, *will God through Jesus*
[4] Gr. *presence.* [5] Or, *exhort* ch. 5. 11.
[6] Some ancient authorities read *as thieves.*
[7] Or, *watch* [8] Or, *comfort* ch. 4. 18.
[9] Many ancient authorities insert *but.*

[a] See Lk. 16. 28; ch. 2. 11; Heb. 2. 6
[b] 1 Pet. 1. 15
[c] ch. 2. 3
[d] Rom. 5. 5; 2 Cor. 1. 22; Gal. 4. 6; 1 Jn. 3. 24
[e] See Jn. 13. 34; Rom. 12. 10
[f] ch. 5. 1; comp. 2 Cor. 9. 1
[g] Jn. 6. 45; 1 Jn. 2. 27; comp. Jer. 31. 33 f.
[h] See ch. 1. 7
[i] See ch. 3. 12
[k] 2 Th. 3. 12
[l] 1 Pet. 4. 15
[m] Eph. 4. 28; 2 Th. 3. 10–12; comp. Acts 18. 3
[n] Rom. 13. 13; Col. 4. 5
[o] See Mk. 4. 11
[p] Comp. Eph. 4. 28
[q] See Rom. 1. 13
[r] See Acts 7. 60
[s] ch. 5. 6; see Eph. 2. 3
[t] Eph. 2. 12
[u] See Rom. 14. 9; 2 Cor. 4. 14
[v] 1 Cor. 15. 18; comp. ver. 15
[x] Comp. 1 K. 13. 17 f.; 20. 35; Gal. 1. 12; 2 Cor. 12. 1
[y] 1 Cor. 15. 52; comp. ch. 5. 10
[z] See ch. 2. 19
[a] See ch. 3. 11
[b] 2 Th. 1. 7; ch. 1. 10
[c] Comp. Joel 2. 11
[d] Comp. Jude 9
[e] See Mt. 24. 31
[f] See 1 Cor. 15. 23; comp. 2 Th. 2. 1; Rev. 14. 13
[g] See 2 Cor. 12. 2
[h] Comp. Dan. 7. 13; Acts 1. 9; Rev. 11. 12
[i] See Jn. 12. 26
[k] Acts 1. 7
[l] See ch. 4. 9
[m] See 1 Cor. 1. 8
[n] See Lk. 21. 34; ver. 4; 2 Pet. 3. 10; comp. Rev. 3. 3; 16. 15
[o] Jer. 6. 14; 8. 11; Ezek. 13. 10
[p] Comp. 2 Th. 1. 9
[q] See Jn. 16. 21
[r] 1 Jn. 2. 8; comp. Acts 26. 18 —
[s] See Lk. 16. 8
[t] See Rom. 13. 11; comp. ver. 10
[u] See Eph. 2. 3; ch. 4. 13
[v] See 1 Pet. 1. 13
[x] Comp. Acts 2. 15; 2 Pet. 2. 13
[y] ver. 5
[z] See Eph. 6. 14
[a] See Eph. 6. 23
[b] See Eph. 6. 17
[c] Comp. Rom. 8. 24
[d] See ch. 1. 10
[e] 2 Th. 2. 13 f.
[f] See Rom. 14. 9
[g] Comp. Eph. 4. 29
[h] See 1 Cor. 16. 18; 1 Tim. 5. 17; comp. Ps. 144. 3
[i] Comp. 1 Cor. 16. 16; Rom. 16. 6, 12; 1 Cor. 15. 10
[k] See Heb. 13. 17
[l] See Mk. 9. 50
[m] 2 Th. 3. 6, 7, 11
[n] Is. 35. 4 (Sept.)
[o] Rom. 14. 1 f.; 1 Cor. 8. 7 ff. (comp. Rom. 15. 1)
[p] See 1 Cor. 13. 4
[q] See Rom. 12. 17; 1 Pet. 3. 9; comp. Mt. 5. 44
[r] Rom. 12. 9; ver. 21; comp. Gal. 6. 10
[s] Phil. 4. 4
[t] See Eph. 6. 18
[u] Eph. 5. 20
[v] Comp. Eph. 4. 30
[x] Comp. Acts 13. 1; 1 Cor. 14. 31
[y] Comp. 1 Cor. 14. 29; 1 Jn. 4. 1
[z] See Rom. 15. 33
[a] See ch. 3. 11

Salutation and Benediction

your [a] spirit and soul and body be preserved entire, [b] without blame at [c] the [1] coming of our Lord Jesus Christ. 24 [d] Faithful is he that [e] calleth you, who will also do it.

25 Brethren, [f] pray for us [2].

26 [g] Salute all the brethren with a holy kiss. 27 I adjure you by the Lord that [h] this epistle be read unto all the [3] [i] brethren.

28 [k] The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you.

[a] Comp. Lk. 1. 46 f.; Heb. 4. 12
[b] 2 Pet. 3. 14; see Jas. 1. 4
[c] See ch. 2. 19
[d] See 1 Cor. 1. 9; 2 Th. 3. 3
[e] See ch. 2. 12
[f] Eph. 6. 19; 2 Th. 3. 1; Heb. 13. 18
[g] See Rom. 16. 16 —
[h] See Col. 4. 16
[i] See Acts 1. 15
[k] See Rom. 16. 20; comp. 2 Th. 3. 18

[1] Gr. *presence.*
[2] Some ancient authorities add *also.*
[3] Many ancient authorities insert *holy.*